

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) |
Detection Strategy | Threat Hunting | Security Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience leading complex security operations, shaping detection strategy, and owning Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms at enterprise scale. I have deep technical ownership of Microsoft Sentinel, including data connectors, analytics rules, workbooks, and SOAR playbook development using Kusto Query Language (KQL) and PowerShell. I hold expert-level proficiency in CrowdStrike Falcon across the NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, and have led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment across an 8,000-user estate. I excel at shaping detection rules, tuning signal-to-noise ratios, building SOAR playbooks, and leading escalated security incident response and advanced threat hunting operations. I am a strong communicator who can articulate complex security findings to technical and non-technical stakeholders, and I bring the operational maturity and engineering depth to take real technical ownership across the full defensive lifecycle.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Ownership and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors, SOAR playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; detection rule authoring, correlation logic, signal-to-noise tuning
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbook development (Logic Apps), PowerShell automation scripts, alert enrichment and automated triage workflows
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** Escalated incident response aligned to NIST 800-61; advanced threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework; proactive hypothesis-led hunting across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based vulnerability prioritisation and remediation oversight
- **Security Tooling:** Mimecast, Tanium, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Check Point Harmony, Splunk/SPL
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Own Microsoft Sentinel end-to-end, including data connector configuration, analytics rule development in KQL, custom workbooks, SOAR playbook authoring (Logic Apps and PowerShell), and ongoing tuning of signal-to-noise ratios across high-volume alert categories.
- Lead detection strategy for the organisation, mapping detection coverage to MITRE ATT&CK techniques and identifying and closing gaps in telemetry and logic; maintain and continuously improve the detection library.

- Own CrowdStrike Falcon platform management across NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, performing advanced threat hunting, behavioural detection engineering, and custom indicator-of-compromise (IOC) management.
- Lead escalated incident response operations aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, performing triage, containment, forensic investigation, eradication, and post-incident review for high-severity and complex security events.
- Conduct advanced threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, developing and executing hypothesis-led hunting campaigns informed by threat intelligence and current adversary TTPs (Tactics, Techniques and Procedures).
- Manage Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, and Defender for Identity across the estate, owning custom detection rules, alert suppression, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified XDR visibility.
- Develop SOAR automation to enrich, correlate, and auto-respond to security alerts, significantly reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common alert patterns.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), overseeing privileged session management and least-privilege enforcement across Windows, Linux, and cloud environments.
- Manage Entra Identity Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies, and Intune MDM/MAM device compliance frameworks.
- Lead vulnerability management activities using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, producing executive-level reporting on risk posture and remediation progress.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Authored and maintained SIEM analytics rules and correlation logic, continuously tuning detections to reduce false positives and improve detection fidelity.
- Performed Tier 2 and Tier 3 security incident response, leading investigations, root-cause analysis, and remediation for complex or escalated security events.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying indicators of compromise and anomalous behaviours across endpoint, network, and identity telemetry.
- Supported the deployment and onboarding of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and BeyondTrust PAM across the estate, contributing to configuration, policy design, and user onboarding.
- Administered Azure Active Directory / Entra Identity IAM functions, including access reviews, MFA enrolment, and SSO integrations.
- Contributed to vulnerability management activities, scanning, triaging, and coordinating remediation in collaboration with infrastructure and application teams.
- Developed internal security documentation, detection runbooks, and incident response playbooks to support SOC operations and knowledge transfer.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered security engineering across a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech cloud environment, implementing endpoint protection, IAM controls, and network security hardening measures.
- Supported security monitoring, log management, and incident response activities, establishing baseline detection and response processes in a high-growth technology environment.
- Managed endpoint security policies, MFA, and access control configurations, aligning controls to CIS benchmarks and organisational security policies.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and implemented a comprehensive detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel at UAL, building a library of KQL-based analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, materially improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates.
- Led the Microsoft Defender XDR deployment across an 8,000-user estate, integrating Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender with Microsoft Sentinel for end-to-end extended detection and response visibility.

- Built and deployed an automated SOAR incident response pipeline using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell, cutting manual analyst handling time for high-volume alert categories and reducing MTTR significantly.
- Owned CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM platform engineering, including data onboarding, detection rule development, and ongoing signal-to-noise optimisation, improving overall SOC efficiency and analyst throughput.
- Led advanced threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL, identifying and containing previously undetected threat actor activity across endpoint and identity layers.
- Delivered the BeyondTrust PAM implementation, eliminating standing privileged credentials and enforcing just-in-time access across server and cloud infrastructure.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.), Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.), Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000 | Hybrid (Manchester/UK)